



01/15/2026

Angela Ricono
549 North Asbury Street
Saint Paul, Minnesota 55104

Dear Angela Ricono,

On behalf of Arts & Sciences, I am pleased to offer you a one-year appointment as a Postdoctoral Research Associate in the Department of Biology the remainder of the spring semesters of the 2025 - 2026 academic year, with a start date of April 1, 2026. This offer may be contingent upon the successful completion of pre-employment screening. This position falls under University and Arts & Sciences postdoctoral policies, with all the status and benefits of a Postdoctoral Research Associate. This offer is made with the expectation that you will successfully complete the requirements of your PhD by the start of the appointment. Please note that continuation of employment within the academic year is contingent upon ongoing satisfactory performance; possibility reappointment for subsequent academic year is contingent upon a successful annual review as well as institutional criteria.

Your salary will be at a rate of \$63,120. Please note that salaries are paid on the last business day of each month. Your monthly rate will be \$5,260. In addition to salary, your compensation will include postdoctoral research associate fringe benefits as described on the Postdoctoral/Research Link found on the Benefits Web page. The URL is <https://hr.washu.edu/benefits>.

This position is On Campus/Onsite.

Offer Letter Response Due Date: 01/22/2026

WashU is committed to maintaining a safe and healthful environment for members of the University community by promoting a tobacco-free environment, as well as one free of the use of drugs and alcohol. All final candidates for appointments will be required to submit to pre-employment background screening. The screenings will include criminal background check and, as applicable for the position, an employment reference check, other background screenings, drug screen, an employment and education or licensure/certification verification, physical examination, certain vaccinations and/or governmental registry checks. All offers are contingent upon successful completion of required screening.

Because your salary is funded by a grant, your employment will be contingent upon the continued receipt of these funds. If your position is eliminated due to the discontinuation of funding, you will be given a minimum of 30 days notice.

Per our discussions, your research will focus on understanding the variability in circadian immunity in the genus *Solanum*. This work will include transcriptomic, metabolomic, and disease work. Additionally, you will mentor graduate students and undergraduates as they work with you towards this goal.

The Postdoctoral Education Policy governs postdoctoral appointments at Washington University. These policies can be accessed at The Office of Postdoctoral Affairs website at <https://postdoc.washu.edu/policies-benefits/>.

Postdoctoral appointees are also offered a generous postdoctoral benefit package, subject to eligibility. For a benefit summary and explanation, please visit the WU Human Resources website at hr.washu.edu/benefits/postdoctoral. Specific questions related to any particular benefit can be addressed by the Human Resources staff, the Office of Postdoctoral Affairs or the Department's Business Office.

You will need you to provide some personal identification information. This information is an important step in our hiring process

and should be entered upon notification. You will be required to provide documentation, such as social security number and citizenship status, proving your identification and employment authorization as dictated by the Immigration Reform and Control Act. The <https://www.uscis.gov/sites/default/files/document/forms/i-9-paper-version.pdf> outlines the requirements and describes the documents that will satisfy these requirements. As completion of this document is mandatory, please ensure that you are able to comply with this request. I would be happy to arrange for you to come in prior to your start date to complete this and other new hire forms.

During your onboarding you will be asked to review and acknowledge applicable University and/or Department policies and to complete required trainings.

The Human Resources staff provides an online orientation program. You must enroll and complete the Learn@Work Orientation session within 31 days of your start date. After completing this session, if you have questions, please contact your HR Partner or for applicable benefits questions, information can be found on the Human Resources website <https://hr.washu.edu/benefits/>.

I am excited about you coming to train with us at WashU and hope you will find this to be a very fulfilling and exciting training environment. I look forward to your joining our team.

Employment with the University is an “at-will” relationship. This means that an employee is free to resign at any time, for any reason. Similarly, the University is free to conclude the employment relationship with or without notice at any time and for any reason.

If the terms of the offer are acceptable to you, please acknowledge your acceptance of this offer on your Candidate Home account.

Sincerely,

Ben Mansfeld
Assistant Professor of Biology